

# Campaign Brief: CMP-006 Spring Flash Sale 2026

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*Cymbal Voyages Brand Studio · Agency onboarding packet · Last updated September 2026*

Flight dates: March 10, 2026 to March 24, 2026. Brief written February 2026.  
Retrospective added April 2026.

## Objective

Lift a soft March by driving bookings across every category with a sitewide 15 percent discount, running two weeks from March 10 to March 24, 2026. March bookings were tracking 12 percent under plan at the end of February, with warm-escape demand tailing off as the travel season winds down and city-break and cruise demand not yet filling the gap. The campaign exists to close that gap inside the month.

## Audience

Segment: `all_customers` (everyone in the CRM, members and non-members) across all markets, plus `prospects` (anonymous and first-time visitors with no account) through paid social and paid search prospecting. Size: about 50,000 CRM contacts, of whom roughly 21,000 are Cymbal Compass members at any tier and 29,000 are non-member customers, plus a modeled prospecting reach of about 400,000 people. Propensity summary: the CRM median warm-escape propensity score is 0.06 in March, with 3 percent of contacts at or above 0.30; because this campaign covers every category, the warm-escape score is only a partial guide. Exclusions: contacts with an active reservation departing inside the sale window, and unsubscribed contacts.

## Insight

A sitewide discount is the fastest lever we have for a volume shortfall, and a two-week window with a visible end date concentrates demand. The prospecting audience in particular responds to a clear, simple number. The retention team has flagged that CMP-003 Winter Sun Early Bird found percent-off with urgency converted worst among Compass members, and asked that members be excluded. The decision was to include members so that the sale reads as one consistent sitewide message, on the reasoning that the volume goal outweighs the framing concern for a two-week flight.

## Channels

Paid social is the primary paid channel, carrying the sale to the CRM match audience and to prospecting audiences in all markets. Frequency cap: three impressions per person per seven days for the matched audience, two for prospecting. Paid search adds sale-term and category-term bidding on top of the always-on brand search program (CMP-001) for the two weeks. Email carries three sends to the full CRM: launch on March 10, a mid-sale reminder on March 17 and a final-day send on March 24 with a countdown module. Frequency cap: two marketing sends per week, which this schedule respects. Direct (site and app) shows a sitewide sale banner and a countdown to March 24. No organic content or affiliate activity is planned beyond notifying partners of the sale dates.

## Offer

Percent off with urgency. Fifteen percent off the package or hotel price on every booking made between March 10 and March 24, 2026, for travel through December 31, 2026, applied automatically at checkout. Flights-only bookings are eligible for 15 percent off the booking fee. The countdown to March 24 appears in email and on site. No points component; Compass members earn standard points on the discounted price.

## Budget and modeled reach

Total budget: \$260,000, new money released from the second-quarter contingency. Paid social: \$135,000, at \$9,000 per day across 15 flight days. Paid search: \$75,000 in incremental sale-term and category bidding. Production: 50,000, *covering creative* (28,000), email build and landing pages (12,000) *and the on-site countdown module* (10,000). The discount itself is treated as reduced revenue, not campaign cost, per finance convention.

Modeled reach: email to about 48,000 deliverable addresses at three sends. Paid social matched audience of about 34,000 CRM contacts plus prospecting reach of about 400,000 people, roughly 1.6 million impressions in total. Paid search modeled at 110,000 incremental clicks.

## KPIs

Booking target: 1,870 confirmed reservations attributed to the campaign by March 24, 2026, modeled as 1,200 from the CRM (2.4 percent of contacts) and 670 from prospecting, with a 30-day post-click window for paid channels and a 7-day post-open window for email. ROI target: 1.5 using the standard formula,  $(\text{attributed revenue} \times 22 \text{ percent contribution margin} - \text{campaign cost}) \div \text{campaign cost}$ , calculated on revenue net of the discount. Secondary measures: cost per booking under \$140, prospecting bookings above 600, and unsubscribe rate held under 0.3 percent per send.

## Creative direction

Imagery: family pool as the lead style for the sitewide message, with city skyline and adventure variants for category placements. Call to action: Claim offer, with See deals on category placements. Headline territory: "15 percent off everything, through March 24." Tone note: direct and simple; the number and the date carry the message, and the copy should stay within the voice guide even while the framing is urgent. No test plan; the flight is too short for a clean read, and the whole CRM receives the same message.

## Legal review notes

Price disclaimer required on every asset showing a price. Discount terms (eligible bookings, travel window, automatic application, flights-only rule) must appear on the landing page and in email footers. Countdown copy is limited to factual statements of the deadline; "last chance" and "don't miss out" are banned. No comparative claims. Imagery licensed for paid and owned use through June 2026. Reviewer and sign-off date: to be completed at legal review.

## Retrospective

Results. The campaign delivered 1,120 confirmed bookings against a target of 1,870, 40 percent under plan, on the full \$260,000 budget. Attributed revenue net of the discount was about \$709,000; at 22 percent contribution margin that is \$156,000 of contribution against \$260,000 of cost, for an ROI of  $-0.4$  against a target of 1.5. Cost per booking was \$232. Average booking value was \$633, far below our cross-category norm of roughly \$2,200, because the sale skewed to single-night hotel stays and flights-only bookings. Finance estimates that the true margin on discounted bookings was closer to 8 percent, so even the  $-0.4$  is a generous reading.

What worked. Prospecting held up: 590 of the 1,120 bookings came from prospects, close to the 670 modeled, and paid search on category terms produced the most efficient bookings in the campaign. City-skyline placements for city breaks outperformed the family-pool lead creative in every market, an early signal for what became CMP-012 Fall City Breaks.

What did not. The CRM delivered 530 bookings against 1,200 modeled. Compass members converted at 0.7 percent against 1.3 percent for non-member customers, the reverse of every other campaign we have run, and Silver and Gold members converted

worst of all. Unsubscribes ran at 0.6 percent on the final-day countdown send, double the guardrail. The post-campaign survey and a review of member service contacts led the post-mortem to one conclusion: the sale cheapened the brand for exactly the customers who value it most. Members who had booked full-price trips in the previous quarter wrote in to ask for the discount retroactively, and several said the countdown "felt like a coupon site."

What we would do differently. Do not run sitewide percent-off to Compass members again; this is now a rule in the creative production standards and the Compass program summary. When March is soft, use free-night framing on specific unsold departures (as CMP-011 Last-Minute Warm Deals did at a 3.4 ROI) or a points offer to active members, and keep discount prospecting to non-member and prospect audiences only. Set the unsubscribe guardrail as a stop condition, not a report line. And listen to the retention team when they cite a retrospective.